1. USB Keyboard and Mouse Problems on Laptops

Five common issues with one possible solution for each

No.	Common issue	Possible solution
1	**Device not detected** – the keyboard or mouse does nothing when plugged in.	Unplug it and try a different USB port; if it still fails, restart the laptop and reinstall the driver from Device Manager.
2	**Jumpy or laggy cursor** – the pointer freezes or moves erratically.	Clean the mouse sensor, use it on a plain mouse pad instead of glass or glossy surfaces, and adjust pointer speed in Settings > Devices > Mouse.
3	**Wrong characters typed** – pressing a key gives a different symbol or letter.	Change the keyboard layout or language in Settings > Time & Language > Language, and turn off Filter Keys and Sticky Keys.
4	**Random disconnecting** – the device works, then drops out.	Turn off USB power saving: in Device Manager open USB Root Hub > Power Management and untick *Allow the computer to turn off this device to save power*.
5	**Wireless USB mouse or keyboard stops** – dead battery or lost pairing with the dongle.	Replace the batteries, plug the dongle straight into the laptop (not a hub), and re-pair using the pairing button.

Quick first test for any problem

Plug the device into another computer. If it works there, the fault is in the laptop settings or driver; if it fails there too, the device itself is faulty and needs replacing.

2. Bluetooth Headphones Not Connecting to the Phone

Step-by-step troubleshooting flow

1. **Check the battery.** Look at the headphone LED: a red or blinking-red light means low battery. Charge for 15 minutes, then switch on.
2. **Check the indicator light.** Flashing blue (or red and blue) means pairing mode; a steady blue light means it is already connected to another device.
3. **Check the phone.** Swipe down the quick panel (or open Settings > Bluetooth) and confirm Bluetooth is ON and Airplane mode is OFF.
4. **Disconnect other devices.** Turn off Bluetooth on any laptop or tablet the headphones were last paired with, as they may be grabbing the connection.
5. **Move closer.** Keep the headphones within 1 to 2 metres of the phone with no obstacles in between.
6. **Enter pairing mode.** Hold the headphone power button for 5 to 7 seconds until the LED flashes blue.
7. **Scan and connect.** On the phone tap *Scan* or *Pair new device*, then tap the headphone name. Enter **0000** if asked for a PIN.
8. **Forget and re-pair.** If the name shows as paired but will not connect, tap the gear icon next to it, choose *Forget / Unpair*, then repeat steps 6 and 7.
9. **Restart.** Switch Bluetooth off and on, then restart the phone and update its software.
10. **Reset.** Factory-reset the headphones (usually hold the buttons for 10 to 15 seconds, see the manual) or reset the phone's network settings.
11. **Isolate the fault.** Try the headphones with another phone. If they work, the problem is the phone; if not, the headphones may be faulty (check warranty).

Also check if connected but silent: media volume is up, and the audio output is set to the headphones.

LED indicator	Meaning	Action
Red blinking	Low battery	Charge the headphones
Blue flashing	Pairing mode	Select the name on the phone
Steady blue / no flash	Connected elsewhere	Disconnect the other device

3. External Webcam Not Detected in Zoom (Windows 10)

Checklist of six things to check or try

- [ ] **1. Check the physical connection**
  Unplug and reconnect the USB cable, try a different USB port (avoid hubs) and another cable. Test the webcam on another PC if possible.

- [ ] **2. Check Device Manager**
  Press Win + X and open Device Manager. Look under *Cameras* or *Imaging devices*. If it is missing or has a yellow warning, right-click it and choose *Update driver*, or *Uninstall device* and click *Scan for hardware changes*.

- [ ] **3. Check Windows privacy settings**
  Settings > Privacy > Camera: turn ON *Allow access to the camera on this device*, *Allow apps to access your camera* and *Allow desktop apps to access your camera* (Zoom is a desktop app).

- [ ] **4. Check Zoom's settings and permissions**
  In Zoom open Settings > Video and choose the external webcam from the *Camera* drop-down. Make sure the video is not stopped in the meeting.

- [ ] **5. Close other apps using the camera**
  Only one app can use the webcam at a time. Close Teams, Skype, browsers and the Camera app (use Task Manager if needed), then reopen Zoom.

- [ ] **6. Update and restart**
  Install Windows and webcam driver updates, update Zoom, restart the PC and check that the webcam's physical privacy shutter or switch is open. Test it in the Windows Camera app.

Quick test

Open the Windows Camera app. If the webcam works there but not in Zoom, the problem is a permission or Zoom setting (items 3 to 5). If it fails there too, focus on the cable, port and driver (items 1, 2 and 6).

4. Printer Shows 'Offline' on a Windows PC

Using the Windows Troubleshooter and what it tells you

Steps

1. **Basic checks first.** Make sure the printer is switched on, has paper and ink, and is connected by USB cable or the same Wi-Fi as the PC.
2. **Open the troubleshooter.** Windows 10: Settings > Update & Security > Troubleshoot > Additional troubleshooters > Printer > *Run the troubleshooter*. Windows 11: Settings > System > Troubleshoot > Other troubleshooters > Printer > *Run*.
3. **Select the printer** that shows offline from the list and click *Next*.
4. **Let it scan.** The tool automatically checks the printer system and may ask for administrator permission.
5. **Apply the fix.** When it offers a solution (for example *Apply this fix*), accept it, then restart the printer and PC.
6. **Test.** Print a test page. If the status still says offline, right-click the printer > *See what's printing* > Printer menu, untick *Use Printer Offline*, or remove and re-add the printer.

Information the troubleshooter provides

What it checks	What it tells you
Print Spooler service	Whether the service is running; it restarts it if stopped.
Printer connection	Whether the printer is reachable over USB or the network.
Print queue	Whether stuck jobs are blocking printing; it can clear them.
Printer driver	Whether the driver is missing or outdated, with a suggestion to update.
Default / offline setting	Whether *Use Printer Offline* is on or the wrong printer is default.
Final report	A status for each problem (Fixed, Not fixed or Not found), plus *View detailed information* for a full list of checks.